

1. ragged, no hyphenation — para-

The composer reads the whole paragraph before it sets a single line, weighing every place a line could end against every other, and it will happily make an early line a little looser if that saves a later one from looking wrong.

A typesetter working by hand had no such luxury. Each line was filled from the left until the next word would not fit, and then the gaps were adjusted until the line was exactly as wide as the measure, which is what most word processors still do today.

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2. ragged, hyphenation — paragraph

Narrow columns are where the difference shows: with only a few words to a line there is very little space to share out, so one long word arriving at the wrong moment can open a gap that the reader sees from across the room.

Hyphenation gives the breaker more ways to stop. Unquestionably the exceptional characteristics of uncharacteristically comprehensive documentation encourage considerable experimentation with typographical conventions.

2. ragged, hyphenation — single-line

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5. justified, spaces never shrink

Short words in a row, as in a list of it, is, as, to, be, or, at, by, on, up, so, no, an, we, he, do, go, me, my, of, if, us, give a line breaker many choices, and bigger ones like documentation and responsibilities give it few.

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6. justified, loose band (60/100/150) —

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7. justified, letter spacing (-5/0/10) —

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9. long words, 80 pt, hyphenation —

Internationaliza-
tion and incom-
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arrive together
in this sentence
so that a mea-
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10. ragged, hyphenation zone 0 —

Hyphenation gives the
breaker more ways to stop.
Unquestionably the excep-
tional characteristics of
uncharacteristically com-
prehensive documentation
encourage considerable
experimentation with typo-
graphical conventions.
Narrow columns are where
the difference shows: with
only a few words to a line
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11. ragged, desired 80 (80/80/100) —

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12. centred, hyphenation — paragraph

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Internationalization and incomprehensibility arrive together in this sentence so that a measure narrower than either word makes the composer break inside them even if it does not want to.

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